

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



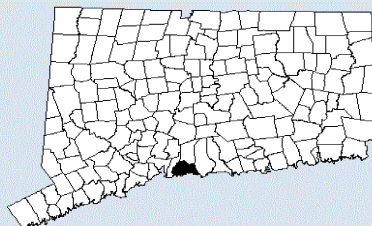
Branford School District

Mr. Hamlet Hernandez, Superintendent • 203-488-7276 • www.branfordschools.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	8
Enrollment	2,590
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$20,467
Total Expenditures ¹	\$58,904,314

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	1,358	52.4	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	181	7.0	5.2
Black or African American	106	4.1	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	353	13.6	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	99	3.8	4.0
White	1,843	71.2	49.9
English Learners	149	5.8	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	975	37.6	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	364	14.1	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	142	11.7	7	0.6
Male	189	14.3	12	0.9
Black or African American	23	21.9	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	96	27.7	*	*
White	186	10.3	12	0.6
English Learners	23	14.7	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	224	25.3	12	1.2
Students with Disabilities	66	19.7	6	1.4
District	331	13.1	19	0.7
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 136

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	207.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	38.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	30.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	93.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	12.3
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	5.0
Support Staff	3.5
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	24.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	20.0
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	167.6

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.7	1.3
Black or African American	2	0.7	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	2.9	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	293	95.8	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.6	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	7	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	15	71.4	24	82.8
White	134	89.9	138	92.0
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	58	81.7	49	84.5
Students with Disabilities	27	77.1	21	65.6
District	173	87.8	189	90.4
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	22	43.1
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	76	68.5
Other Health Impairment	45	77.6
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	47	87.0
District	211	62.4
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	54	2.1	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	40	1.5	1.1
Intellectual Disability	7	0.3	0.5
Learning Disability	111	4.3	5.8
Other Health Impairment	58	2.2	3.3
Other Disabilities	26	1.0	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	62	2.4	1.9
All Disabilities	358	13.7	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	23	6.4	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	10	2.8	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$33,209,480	\$11,539	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$5,140,674	\$1,841	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$5,257,560	\$1,883	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$1,879,813	\$673	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$2,786,080	\$998	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$1,890,246	\$677	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$5,297,229	\$1,897	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$2,604,525	\$916	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$838,707	\$300	\$151
Total	\$58,904,314	\$20,467	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$4,220,615	34.9	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,713,305	14.2	11.1
Other Salaries	\$404,137	3.3	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,937,789	16.0	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$603,001	5.0	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,599,497	21.5	22.5
Supplies	\$69,546	0.6	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$533,292	4.4	7.2
Equipment	\$4,395	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$680	0.0	0.1
Total	\$12,086,258	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		20.5	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	92.1
State	6.3
Federal	1.2
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	6	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	23	82.6
English Learners	7	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	82	89.0
Students with Disabilities	27	66.7
District	239	92.5
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	95.3	83	43.5
Male	81.9	71	33.0
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	72.0	10	20.0
White	91.3	120	40.1
English Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	81.4	30	23.3
Students with Disabilities	64.2	0	0.0
District	88.2	154	37.9
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	85.5	88.2
Male	58.0	81.3
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	72.9	84.7
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	56.4	79.2
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	71.7	85.4
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	13.1%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	21.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	89.2%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	37.9%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		90.6%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		92.5%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		93.2%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		71.7%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		56.8%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	93.2%	0.8%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Branford School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

As the Branford Public Schools prepared for the 2020-21 school year amidst a global pandemic, staff, students, families, and other stakeholders contributed to the development of the reopening plan, guided by three priorities: (1) promoting student and staff physical health and emotional well-being, (2) ensuring equity and access for all students to high quality, rigorous learning, (3) creating sustainability and capacity to respond to change. These priorities reflected the district's commitment to protecting the safety of its students, staff, and community while continuing to be guided by its Strategic Success Plan. The District monitored progress in a range of ways, from COVID-specific statistics to measures of student connectedness and curriculum-based assessments of learning progress. Stakeholder input was gathered through communication structures such as surveys, public comment at BOE meetings, a town forum, and parent feedback. BPS remained in a hybrid model throughout the school year, returning to a full-in person model at the start of April 2021.

Given the demands of the hybrid model and the challenges associated with the Voluntary Remote Option required by the state, the Student Services Department worked closely with central office and other stakeholders to assure students with disabilities received grade-level content (as appropriate), specialized instruction, and related service supports, and any accommodations and/or modifications required by their IEPs. The hybrid model included collaboration time for special education teachers, related services staff, interventionists, and classroom teachers to ensure students with disabilities receive their mandated continuum of services.

To that end, Student Services maintains 17 Level-1 and 3 Level-2 certified Wilson instructors as well as an in-district Wilson trainer, with another in progress. We further employ 4 certified Crisis Prevention Institute trainers, 4 BCBAs working as teachers and as cross-departmental consultants, 2 trained PATH futures planning facilitators, and a trained neurocognitive evaluator. Programmatically, for low incident handicaps, we have enhanced the rigor of our ABA programs at both the Pre-K and K-4 levels. This growth has extended to our Life Skills programs at Walsh and BHS. The Department also broadened its scope of services and deepened its community relationships within its 18-22-year-old transition program. In support of these actions, the district provided consultation and/or training for administrators, teachers, and paraprofessionals around using data, implementing high leverage, high impact instructional practices and designing compliant IEPs.

District efforts at truancy prevention focused on ensuring that all students had access to learning, whether participating in the hybrid or exercising the option for remote learning. All students were provided with a district device for accessing the internet, and any family lacking wifi service was given a hotspot. School-based student support teams met on a weekly basis to identify and reconnect disconnected students and families, implementing a variety of strategies, from ongoing virtual wellness check-ins to regular home visits.

The District also worked to keep all families connected despite COVID required restrictions on school visitors. Building principals held virtual coffees to hear from parents.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As the demographics of the Branford Public School community continue to evolve, the District has been striving to increase the representation of minority staff members through informal outreach and recruitment and collaboration with our area RESC. The incoming class of newly hired certified staff for the 2020-21 school year had 20% BIPOC representation, significantly higher than the proportion of BIPOC teachers in the district's existing workforce.

In 2020-21, a total of 41 Branford students were enrolled in schools of choice, including magnet and charter schools, representing a 9% decrease in that total from the previous year. The number of Open Choice students enrolled in Branford Public Schools decreased by 10% to a total of 54%.

In support of the District's focus on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion, a district leadership group attended an Anti-Racist Educator Framework professional learning series, school staff sponsored and participated in anti-racism book studies at the high school and intermediate school, and provided professional development to pre-Kindergarten teachers and paraprofessionals on culturally relevant pedagogy. The District continues to expand school and classroom library collections to better reflect our diverse student body and to offer readers an opportunity to explore worlds other than their own. DEI is an integral consideration in all curriculum development, including professional learning that focuses on equity-centered pedagogy. Extracurricular offerings at the intermediate school were expanded to include an African American Club, and all schools look forward to a pre-pandemic time when it will be possible to resume in-person celebrations of the vast array of world cultures reflected in their student bodies.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Branford School District's budget development process is designed to provide equity across schools and programs while addressing student needs. Teacher leaders, school principals, and district department leaders generate budget requests that are considered by the central office staff through the lens of equity in the allocation of resources, and with consideration for the district's emerging needs and now those needs are distributed across the different schools and programs.

As the budget process unfolds, there is additional scrutiny and ongoing communication and collaboration with school and department leaders to ensure equity across the levels. Reasonable class size continues to be a priority for the district as does support of the district's strategic success plan and a focus on emerging needs, such as students' social and emotional learning, the inclusion and education of students with disabilities, and supporting students from diverse backgrounds.